



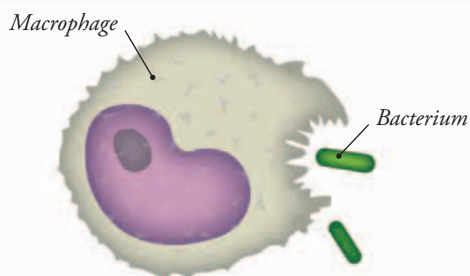
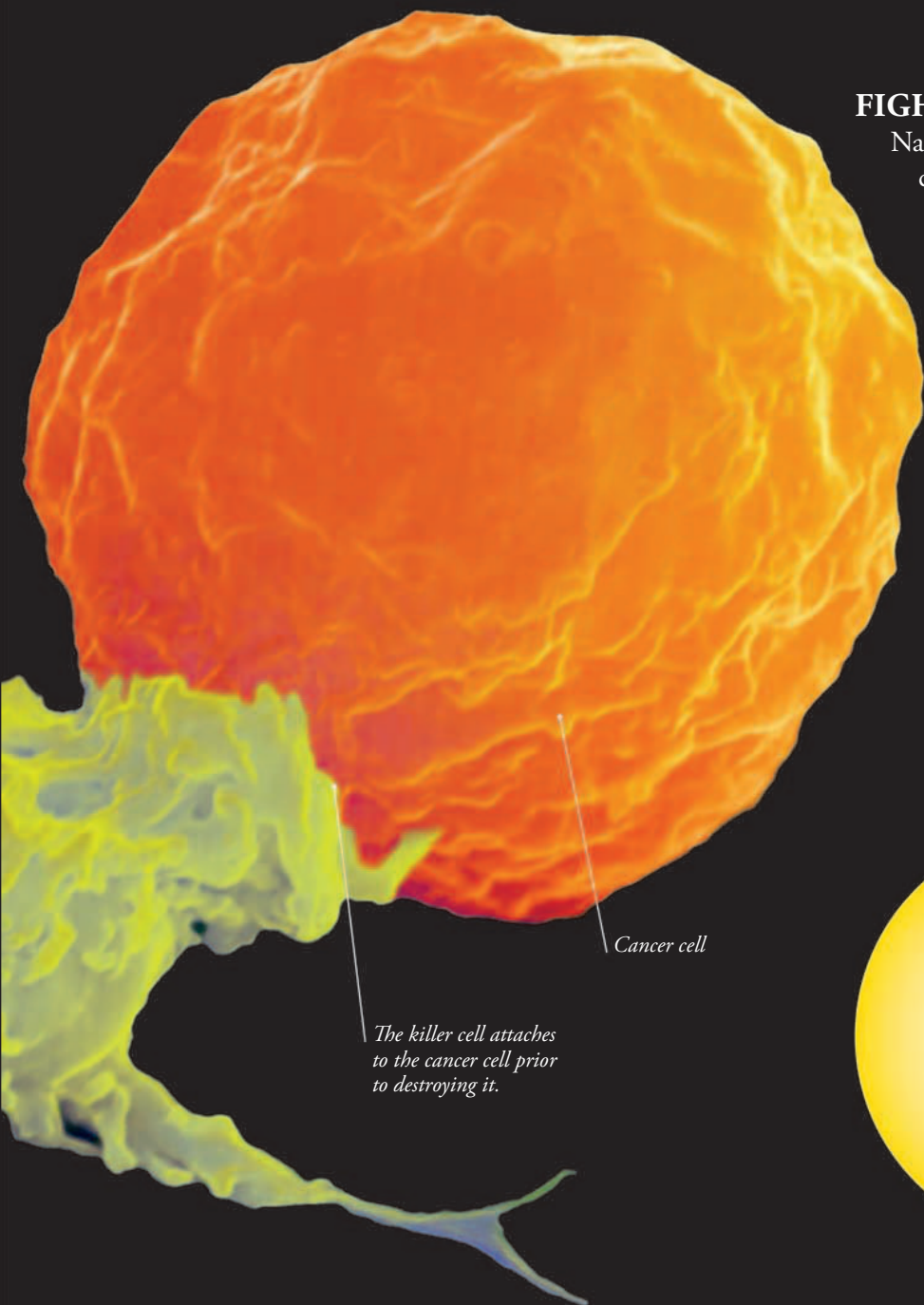
FIGHTING CANCER

Natural killer cells are white blood cells that defend the body against cancer and viruses. When a natural killer cell finds a cancer cell, it punches holes in its prey and injects poisons that kill the cancer cell from the inside.

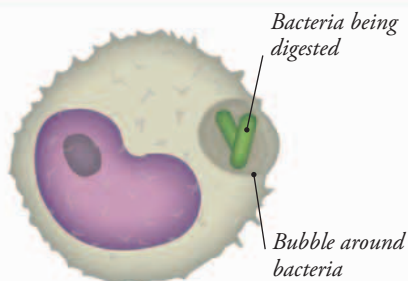
◀ **CANCER KILLER** A natural killer cell (green) makes contact with a cancer cell (orange). The killer cell identifies the cancer cell as abnormal by analyzing chemicals on its surface.

WOW!

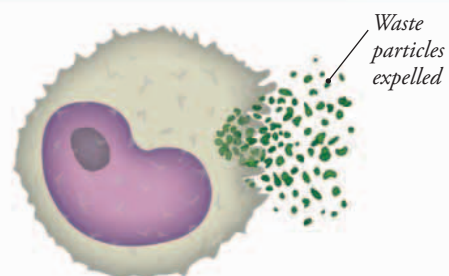
A single drop of blood may contain as many as 25,000 white blood cells.



▲ **CAPTURE** A macrophage identifies a bacterium as foreign and rapidly alters shape to surround and swallow its prey.



▲ **DIGEST** The captured bacteria are enclosed in a kind of bubble (a vesicle) and doused in powerful enzymes that kill and digest them.



▲ **EXPEL** Undigested waste is expelled from the macrophage, which then continues its search for more harmful bacteria.